



FOR THE NGOS CARRYING SO MUCH, FOR SO MANY

## Someone to sit with them, **even when you cannot.**

You already carry their food, their shelter, their safety, their paperwork, their case files, their futures. This is about the one thing no field visit can cover every hour of every day — what happens in their mind at 2am, in a language only they feel safe in, when no one else is there.

AN OLD STORY, TOLD IN EVERY LANGUAGE

*Every culture we know has one version of the same story: someone who simply sits with another person's pain, without flinching, without fixing it too quickly, without judging what they find there.*

In the Ramayana, when Hanuman finally finds Sita held captive in Lanka, he does not rush forward with news or advice. He sits quietly first. He lets her see that he is safe to be near. Only then does he speak. In Sufi teaching stories, a murshid — a guide — is said to ask no more than the seeker is ready to answer, and to wait, patiently, for as many seasons as it takes. In countless oral traditions carried by grandmothers around a fire, the healer is rarely the one with the cleverest answer — it is the one who stays through the whole story, the hard middle included.

We did not invent this idea. We simply tried to build a companion who could offer a version of it to someone, at any hour, in their own tongue — **Hindi, Bengali, Tamil, Telugu, Urdu, Arabic, and seventeen languages more** — whether or not a trained counsellor happens to be within reach that night.

### A STORY IMOTARA ITSELF SOMETIMES TELLS

*"In the Ramayana, when Hanuman finds Sita imprisoned in Lanka, he does not immediately deliver Ram's message. He first sits quietly, watches, lets her see that he is safe. Then he speaks. The story asks us to read the state before we act."*

— one of the culturally-rooted reflections Imotara's own companion engine can draw on mid-conversation

This guide is about what happens in that space between your field visits — the quiet hours your team cannot physically fill, however much you want to. It explains, in plain terms, the psychological ideas Imotara draws from, and how they show up as something a person can actually use on their phone, tonight, in their own language. Not as a replacement for your people. As one more set of hands, holding what your team already holds.





## You already know exactly who we mean.

The survivor rebuilding a life from nothing. The teenager aging out of care with no one to call at night. The displaced family holding onto dignity in a temporary shelter. The elder your outreach visits once a fortnight, alone the other thirteen days. The field worker who carries all of their stories home too.

### TWO KINDS OF CARE, WORKING TOGETHER

Your organisation is already doing the harder, more human half of this work — the food, the shelter, the legal aid, the case management, the simple act of showing up in person, again and again. That work cannot be replaced by an app, and Imotara is not built to try. What Imotara can take on is narrower, and more specific: **the inner weather** — the anxiety that arrives at midnight, the grief that has nowhere to go on a Sunday, the shame that keeps someone from saying the hard thing out loud even to a trusted case worker.

Between your visits, between your intake sessions, between the field worker's calls — there are hundreds of ordinary hours. Imotara's only job is to be a steady, private, judgment-free presence in those hours, so that by the time your team is back in the room, the person in front of you is a little less alone with what they've been carrying.

### WHAT WE PROMISE YOU, IN WRITING



#### Never a diagnosis, never a treatment claim

Imotara is a wellness companion, not a clinician. It never diagnoses a condition and never claims to replace therapy, psychiatry, or your professional referral pathways.



#### Never a substitute for crisis response

Imotara is not an emergency service. Your existing crisis protocols and helpline referrals remain the front line for acute risk — Imotara sits alongside them, never instead of them.



#### Never seen by your organisation

What a beneficiary tells Imotara is never exposed to your dashboard — not the words, not the mood entries, not the identity behind them. Only aggregate, anonymised trends, ever.



#### Never instead of your team

Imotara fills the hours your field workers physically cannot. It is designed to complement human care, not to give anyone a reason to visit less.

### FIRST, IMOTARA LISTENS FOR WHAT'S UNDERNEATH

Before offering anything, it reads the room. The oldest rule of real listening — in psychology and in the old stories alike — is that you cannot help someone until you understand where they actually are.

Dr. Stephen Porges' polyvagal theory describes three nervous-system states a person can be in during distress: **calm and connected**, **flooded** (fight-or-flight, racing thoughts, panic), or **shut down** (numbness, dissociation, "nothing matters"). Trying to problem-solve with someone who is flooded, or trying to do deep reflection with someone who has shut down, doesn't just fail — it can make things worse. The right response depends entirely on which state a person is actually in.



#### NERVOUS-SYSTEM-AWARE LISTENING

##### Reading the state before choosing what to offer

Before Imotara replies, it reads for signals of flooding, shutdown, or calm engagement in what someone has written — then chooses a genuinely different kind of response for each: slowing everything down for panic, gentle warmth for numbness, real conversation for someone who is present and ready to reflect.



#### SECONDARY-EMOTION AWARENESS

##### Looking beneath the stated feeling

Anger often carries fear or grief underneath it. Withdrawal often carries shame. Imotara is built to notice what's likely underneath the surface feeling, not just react to the word on top of it — the way a perceptive elder in any community learns to hear what a young person isn't quite saying yet.



#### VALIDATION BEFORE ANYTHING ELSE

##### Acknowledge first. Always.

Every reply follows the same order: regulate the moment first, validate what the person feels second, and only then — if at all — offer any kind of guidance. Advice offered before someone feels heard rarely lands. Imotara is built never to skip the first two steps.



## When the ground feels unsteady, the body comes first.

Grounding is one of the oldest human technologies — long before it had a clinical name, it was a breath, a hand on the earth, a moment of stillness before the next hard thing.

### GROUNDING & REGULATION



#### GUIDED BREATHING

##### A breathing companion, one tap away in chat

A guided-breathing exercise a beneficiary can open mid-conversation, any time a moment feels like too much — an old, simple technology (breath as anchor) available instantly, in a pocket, with no appointment needed.



#### SENSORY GROUNDING, IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

##### "Name 5 things you can see. Feel your feet on the floor."

For panic or dissociation, Imotara can walk someone through simple, body-based grounding — noticing what's physically around them, feeling their feet on the ground — bringing the nervous system back to the present moment before anything else is discussed.

### DAILY EMOTIONAL AWARENESS



#### MOOD CHECK-INS

##### Naming the feeling, one day at a time

A short daily check-in across eight emotional states. Simply naming what you feel — a practice old wisdom traditions and modern psychology agree on — is often the first quiet step toward understanding it.



#### SELF-COMPASSION PRACTICE

##### The voice someone would use for a friend — turned inward

When self-criticism runs high, Imotara can gently invite someone to notice: would you say this to your closest friend? If not, why does it feel fair to say to yourself? A practice as old as compassion itself, offered back in the person's own words.

#### A STORY IMOTARA ITSELF SOMETIMES TELLS

*"In Buddhism, metta — loving-kindness — begins with the self before it extends to others. You cannot pour from an empty vessel."*

— offered in-app during moments of harsh self-criticism, across traditions and languages



##### Chosen, never imposed

A beneficiary can choose the companion that helps them most — a Friend, an Elder, a Mentor, a Coach — and whether they want comfort, reflection, motivation, or plain advice in that moment. The same care, shaped to what the person in front of it actually needs, the way a village doesn't send the same person to comfort every kind of grief.



## Every hard chapter is still only one chapter.

Every mythology we know is, underneath, the story of someone who carried something heavy and was changed by it — not broken by it. Imotara tries to help a person notice that they are living one of these stories too.

### NOTICING PATTERNS, WITHOUT JUDGMENT



#### EMOTIONAL OPEN LOOPS

##### Gently naming the loop, when someone keeps returning to it

If the same unresolved pain surfaces across several conversations, Imotara can name the pattern gently — the way a trusted old friend might say, "you've mentioned this a few times now" — never as a diagnosis, only as an invitation to look at it together.



#### STRENGTH-SPOTTING

##### Naming what's already going right

Drawing on Martin Seligman's positive psychology, Imotara looks for real evidence of a person's strength — not invented praise — and names it: "you came here, you said this out loud, that's not nothing." Real capacities, honestly noticed.

### TURNING THE PAGE INTO A STORY, ON PAPER



#### GUIDED JOURNALING

##### Writing what hurts loosens its grip

A private, optional journal with gentle prompts — expressive writing is one of the most consistently evidence-backed tools in psychology, and here it stays completely private, never synced anywhere, only ever read by its author.



#### THE UNSENT LETTER

##### Saying the unsayable thing — safely, to no one

A letter written to someone who hurt you, or to the version of yourself who didn't yet know better — that never has to be sent. An old grief practice found across many cultures, offered here as a private, judgment-free ritual.



#### THE EMOTIONAL ARC & THE COMPANION'S LETTER

##### Reading your own month back as a story of becoming

Once a month, Imotara can write back a short reflection — in the person's own words — reframing what happened not just as hardship endured, but as the beginning of who they're becoming. A yearly version closes the loop again each December.



#### FUTURE LETTERS

##### A letter to the self who has already survived this

A time-locked letter written today, to be opened by the same person weeks or months from now — a quiet act of hope, addressed to someone who, by the time they read it, will already have come through.

#### REAL STORIES IMOTARA SOMETIMES DRAWS ON

Nelson Mandela called his memoir *Long Walk to Freedom* — not just from apartheid, but to himself. Viktor Frankl survived a concentration camp and wrote that suffering with meaning is bearable in a way suffering without it never is. These are not myths — they are real people whose stories Imotara can offer, gently, when someone needs to know that what they're carrying has been carried, and survived, before.



## Wisdom doesn't only travel in English.

The stories that comfort someone in Lucknow may not be the ones that comfort someone in Kochi, or Karachi, or Kyoto — so Imotara doesn't offer just one tradition's wisdom to everyone.

### A DIFFERENT WELL OF STORIES FOR EVERY LANGUAGE

Imotara's own storytelling engine draws from many traditions, and quietly matches the tradition to the person: a Hindi speaker may hear something from the Gita, the Ramayana, or the Upanishads; an Arabic speaker may hear Sufi wisdom, in the spirit of Rumi; a Japanese speaker may hear a Zen parable about impermanence; others may hear a Greek, Norse, or Shinto myth, or the real story of someone like Mandela, Frankl, or Kalam who carried something heavy and was changed, not broken, by it. No single culture's stories are treated as the "default" — every tradition is offered as equally wise.

● Hindi, Bengali, Tamil, Telugu & 8 more Indian languages

● Urdu & Arabic

● Japanese, Chinese, Indonesian

● Spanish, French, German, Russian, Portuguese, Hebrew



#### DIGNITY IN LANGUAGE

##### Not just translated — spoken to correctly

Even grammatical details like gendered verb forms in Hindi, Bengali, and other Indic languages are handled properly — a small thing that, said wrong, can quietly tell someone this tool wasn't really built for them. Imotara is built so it was.



#### YOU ARE NOT THE ONLY ONE

##### A collective pulse, with no names attached

A gentle, anonymous signal of what others are feeling today — a quiet reminder of a truth every support group already knows: that being understood by others who feel it too is its own kind of relief, even with no names ever shared.



#### SUPPORT THAT DOESN'T STOP WHEN THE SIGNAL DOES

##### Offline fallback, for the places connectivity forgets

Many of the beneficiaries you serve live where the network is unreliable. Imotara's offline mode keeps a version of this support working even without it — because the people most in need of reaching someone are often the hardest for a signal to reach.



#### HONEST HOPE, NEVER HOLLOW POSITIVITY

##### No "everything happens for a reason"

Imotara is built never to offer hollow comfort — no "it'll be fine," no toxic positivity. On lighter days, it can offer real warmth, and even gentle humour — but the hope it offers is always earned, grounded in what's actually true.





## Knowing the edges of a tool is part of using it well.

We would rather tell you plainly what Imotara is not, than let your team discover a limit in a moment that matters.

### BOUNDARIES WE HOLD SERIOUSLY



#### **Not a crisis line, not an emergency service**

If a beneficiary is in acute danger, your existing crisis protocols, helplines, and emergency referral pathways remain the correct first response — always. Imotara is built to encourage reaching out to real, immediate human help when risk is high, not to stand in for it.



#### **Not a diagnosis, not a course of treatment**

Imotara doesn't diagnose depression, PTSD, or any other condition, and it isn't a substitute for psychiatric care or licensed therapy. Where deeper clinical support is needed, Imotara is designed to sit alongside it, pointing people toward it — never in place of it.



#### **Not a replacement for your field team's judgment**

The people who know your beneficiaries' full circumstances, history, and needs are your case workers, not an app. Imotara doesn't make placement, safeguarding, or programme decisions — those stay entirely with your team.

### HOW THE TWO KINDS OF CARE LINE UP

Think of it as two different shifts, covering the same person. Your field workers bring what only a present, trained human being can bring: judgment, safeguarding, resources, a hand to hold in the hardest moments. Imotara covers the long, ordinary hours in between — not instead of your team, but so that by the next time your team is in the room, the person in front of them has had somewhere private to put down what they've been carrying alone.



#### **And your organisation still sees only the aggregate**

Even as Imotara does this deeply personal work with each beneficiary, what your admin dashboard shows stays exactly as promised elsewhere in your Imotara licence: engagement trends, never an individual's words, mood entries, or identity.



## The story ends where it began.

With someone who stayed long enough to listen.

### ONE MORE STORY

Every tradition we know tells some version of the same truth: *a person who is truly heard carries their burden differently afterward* — not lighter, necessarily, but no longer alone with it.

Your organisation already gives the people you serve so much of what a hard life takes away — shelter, safety, dignity, a future worth planning for. Imotara can't walk beside them in the field, and it was never built to try. But it can sit with them at 2am, in their own language, for as long as it takes, using ideas drawn from real psychology and even older wisdom — until your team can be there again.

That is the whole of what we set out to build. We hope it earns a place alongside the work you're already doing.

### SEE IT FOR YOURSELF — SCAN TO DOWNLOAD



#### Web App

Scan to open [imotara.com](https://imotara.com) — no install needed.



#### App Store

Scan to download for iPhone & iPad.



#### Google Play

Scan to download for Android.

### Want to talk through what this could mean for your beneficiaries?

Share your programme's needs — we'll help you think through what fits, and what doesn't.

[info@imotara.com](mailto:info@imotara.com)

[imotara.com](https://imotara.com) · Response within 48 hours

